

BRANDDON COELHO

Senior Software Engineer

Application Architect

Lead Developer

 <https://branndon.dev/linkedin>  <https://github.com/BranndonWork>  <https://branndon.dev/>  resume@branndon.dev

ABOUT BRANDDON

- Seasoned software engineer with over 15 years of professional experience in **backend development** and technical leadership. Led technical initiatives at The Penny Hoarder from startup to recognized media platform, orchestrating critical business applications, optimizing site performance from 2.7 seconds to 0.89, designing a **machine learning-based** email content recommendation system, and building a production Single Page Application job portal with **Node.js** WebSocket backend and automated testing. Contributed to transforming the company from \$4 million to \$40 million in annual revenue while scaling technical teams from 10 to over 100 employees.

Currently at Headspace, specializing in **Django-based application development** with focus on **scalable** and **security-focused** software architecture. Responsibilities include mentoring junior engineers, guiding software architecture decisions, and ensuring adherence to industry best practices while staying current with **Django framework** enhancements.

Technical expertise spans **Python**, **Django**, **RESTful API** design, **PostgreSQL**, **Redis**, **AWS services**, **Docker**, and modern development workflows. Experienced in GDPR compliance, data anonymization, and building systems that scale under load.

Branndon's top 5 professional strengths in order are:

- [Strategic - naturally spots patterns and alternative pathways to solutions](#)
- [Activator - naturally takes initiative and makes things happen quickly](#)
- [Individualization - notices unique qualities and tailors approach accordingly](#)
- [Achiever - driven by constant accomplishment and works with stamina](#)
- [Adaptability - able to switch gears quickly when priorities change](#)

Source: Gallup/Clifton Strengths Finder <https://www.gallup.com/cliftonstrengths/en/252137/home.aspx>

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Complete work history: <https://branndon.dev/linkedin>

Senior Software Engineer - [Headspace](#)

2022 - Present

Lead development of **Django-based applications** and major platform initiatives including Server-Driven UI project, where I transitioned from **Python** to **TypeScript** to enhance existing **Node.js** Hapi API system with server-driven UI capabilities, converting all mobile app display logic to server-side control. Led the onboarding flow team while ensuring **GDPR compliance** throughout the project lifecycle.

Supported Headspace-Ginger platform merger project integration combining Headspace meditation app with Ginger's coaching and clinical therapy services. Extended platform to allow teenagers access to coaching services with guardian consent mechanisms. Built guardian consent workflows and led SMS architecture migration using **Braze API integration**, eliminating dual-source synchronization issues.

Lead technical decisions while mentoring engineers in **Django best practices** and system architecture.

Design **RESTful APIs** for complex environments while promoting code quality and performance optimization across cross-functional teams. Implemented GDPR compliance workflows and data anonymization for DSAR requests.

Achievements:

- Led team for onboarding flow conversion in company-wide Server-Driven UI initiative, enhancing Node.js Hapi API system with TypeScript SDUI capabilities while ensuring GDPR compliance
- Project lead for SMS consent architecture migration from dual-source to single-source using Braze API integration, eliminating synchronization issues and improving system reliability
- Implemented proper data anonymization workflows for DSAR account deletion compliance
- Extended platform capabilities for Ginger For Teens project, developing guardian consent mechanisms and age-appropriate access controls for teen coaching services

Technologies Touched (in order of usage):

Python, Django, Backend Development, PostgreSQL, RESTful API, TypeScript, Node.js, Docker, GDPR Compliance, Data Anonymization

○ Application Architect / Lead Developer / Senior Developer - [The Penny Hoarder](#)

2014 - 2020

Drove the design and deployment of critical business applications including real-time dashboards showing live site metrics, administrative interfaces, and automated reporting systems. Implemented **Redis pub/sub architecture** for real-time data updates, intelligent caching strategies with configurable TTL, and **Amazon SQS queues** for background job processing. Architected multi-system integration connecting **Redshift data warehouse** to **AWS Lambda-based** ML processing pipeline.

Built comprehensive WFH Jobs Portal SPA using **Node.js WebSocket backend** for real-time updates, custom WordPress API integration, and Protractor/Selenium automated testing suite. Implemented advanced search filtering, dynamic routing with HTML5 History API, and multi-dimensional job categorization.

Contributed to team growth by leading weekly code reviews, mentoring developers, and collaborating with both executive staff and project management to align technical and business goals.

Achievements:

- **Application Architect**
 - Optimized site load time from 2.7 seconds to 0.89 seconds, resulting in significant cost savings and revenue increase
 - Designed and built **machine learning-based** email content recommendation system integrating Redshift analytics, AWS Lambda processing, and Iterable email platform for personalized content delivery at scale using Redis caching and pub/sub architecture
 - Architected and built production Single Page Application job search portal with Node.js WebSocket backend, real-time search filtering, and comprehensive automated testing suite using Protractor/Selenium
 - Contributed to company growth from \$4M to \$40M annual revenue while scaling technical team from 10 to 100+ employees

Technologies Touched (in order of usage):

Python, Machine Learning, Node.js, Redis, PostgreSQL, AWS Lambda, Amazon Redshift, Amazon SQS, Flask

○ Senior Software Engineer - [Webley Systems](#)

2020 - 2021

Spearheaded the development of a real-time screen capture system similar to Loom, architecting **backend infrastructure** to receive video chunks every 10 seconds, store them in **AWS S3**, and combine them for seamless playback. Built scalable video processing pipeline generating HLS playlists (m3u8) for real-time video delivery. Employed **Flask** for **RESTful API** development and utilized **Python's** advanced features like decorators and context managers while interfacing with React frontend.

Achievements:

- Achieved proficiency in **Flask** and embraced **TDD principles** through dedicated training sessions
- Engineered real-time video processing system handling fragmented video segments, automatically generating HLS streaming playlists for immediate playback. Autonomously designed distributed API infrastructure leveraging **AWS Lambda**, API Gateway, and ALB to manage concurrent video uploads and real-time segment processing

- Ensured robust software delivery by authoring comprehensive tests for both legacy systems and new implementations

Technologies Touched (in order of usage):

Python, Flask, TDD, RESTful API, AWS Lambda, AWS S3, Real-time Systems

Professional recommendations continue on the following page

RECOMMENDATIONS

Additional recommendations: <https://branndon.dev/linkedin>

○ Kyle Taylor

CEO | The Penny Hoarder

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/kylebradleytaylor>

I've been lucky enough to work alongside Brandon for nearly two years now and while he's always been a pleasure to work with, I feel like this year in particular has brought about a huge transformation. He has a growing confidence in his skills and abilities and it's been such a pleasure to watch him realize his own talent.

○ Stephen McDermott

IT Director | The Penny Hoarder

<https://linkedin.com/in/stephenmcdermott>

The code looks to be easily maintainable and modular. I have noticed that when creating deliverables, regression testing is relatively isolated. A poorly coded site would include multiple cross dependencies, whereas one change would result in changes across the whole system. Brandon has coded a good portion of this site and it is built well.

○ Jennifer Franko

Scrum Master II | The Penny Hoarder

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/jenniferfranko>

Brandon is one of the most well rounded, patient and talented developers I have had the pleasure to work with. Brandon is always thinking of the user experience as he works on his outstanding coding. Brandon never shows signs of stress and was always able to successfully complete any tasks with favorable results despite deadline pressure. His technical skill is outstanding but he also has the ability to communicate clearly and to collaborate effectively.

Brandon is a rare find within the development world as he is constantly furthering his knowledge and skills. He repetitively amazed me with his industry insight and original approaches to solving problems.

Brandon always takes the time to provide technical guidance and mentorship to his fellow developers. Brandon leads by example and people find his enthusiasm and dedication both inspiring and motivating.

Brandon is dedicated, self-motivated, methodical, and very capable. I thoroughly enjoyed working with him at The Penny Hoarder and hope that one day I will have the privilege to work with him again. He is a true Rock Star!!!